

Thank you so much for your interest in *Crows*, a post-apocalyptic, survival horror, fantasy tabletop roleplaying game from MCDM. Put on your wizard hat and get rich or die trying in a harsh world of hideous monsters lurking in forgotten ruins.

What you have is the first public playtest packet of the game, which is still in early stages of development. Your feedback will help us shape *Crows*, so we're eager to know what you like and don't like.

Here's what's inside:

- A booklet containing the game's core rules
- A booklet containing character creation and advancement options, rules for gear, and rules for creating and advancing the PCs' village
- An adventure to, in, and from the Blood Library, a flesh-covered ruin containing spellbooks and other treasures
- A booklet containing the statistics of creatures used in the Blood Library
- Maps and art needed for the dungeon. The art is from the great Nick De Spain!

A few caveats about the game right now:

- It has not been properly edited. With the game in early stages, it isn't worth the time right now to edit everything. You'll see typos and sentences that could be phrased better and information organization that could be improved. You don't need to let us know about that! That should be fixed by the time we publish.
- It has not been properly laid out. This is nowhere close to the final graphic treatment of the game, especially when it comes to cards, stat blocks, trait trees, and the like. There will be more symbols and much better graphic design at later stages of development.
- There's a lot more coming. More equipment, monsters, dungeons, pets, encounter tables, and village institutions! Rules for hirelings and vehicles! There's also going to be A LOT more advice for the Ref coming. The rules reference a booklet called *The Ref*, which has yet to be written.
- If you're only ever played heroic fantasy games, this is going to feel very different. *Crows* is a game about gritty dungeon survival. PCs die easily. Obstacles can be overcome without rolling dice. Don't expect to kick in every door and destroy every enemy in every room of the dungeon. If this game were *Resident Evil Requiem*, it's the Grace sections, not the Leon sections.
- The playtest materials include a lot of information about the game's progression, but only a handful of monsters and a single dungeon. We wanted to give you an idea of what progression in the game looks like without having to write the entire game before testing. We assume most groups aren't going to do more than play the one included dungeon.

This is a playtest! Right now the game is in such early stages of development that anything can change, and we really want to know what you think after you get a chance to play *Crows*. You can do that by filling out this survey: crows.gg/PlaytestSurvey. It's for players and Refs alike!

The survey will close Monday June 29th at 8AM Eastern Pacific time. The survey is the BEST way to get us feedback. We ask that you don't put suggestions for changes in the survey, but rather tell us what you don't like about *Crows*. When folks make suggestions, they tend to suggest something we've already thought of and don't tell us what they're trying to fix, which can leave us scratching our heads. Also, please don't link to other documents or sites in the survey. We'll only be looking at feedback you write into the form.

[Sign up here to get an email when the *Crows* BackerKit campaign goes live.](#)

To find a group that's playtesting or to get in on the conversation about *Crows*, you can [join the new *Crows* subreddit](#) or [join to the MCDM Discord](#). You can also [subscribe to MCDM on YouTube](#) to get development updates. I also do pretty frequent updates on [Twitch](#) and right here on Patreon for [MCDM+ Patrons](#).

Thank you again for checking out our game! Fortune or death!

—James